Sharini Rao

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Education

University of California, Berkeley **Berkeley, CA**

B.A. Data Science (Business Emphasis) *Expected May 2027*

- Berkeley Certificate in Design Innovation (In Progress) | SCET Certificate in Entrepreneurship & Technology (In Progress)
- **Relevant Coursework:** Human-Centered Product Design, Bio-Inspired Design, Data Structures, Probability & Statistics, Data Visualization, Data Mining and Analytics, Data Engineering

Experience

Associate Strategy Consultant **Sep 2026 – Present**

FEED (Food, Equity, Entrepreneurship, & Development) – Lotus Foods *Berkeley, CA*

- Building an EPR compliance framework to help Lotus Foods leadership meet new packaging laws across 7 states, by owning all of Oregon's research on packaging fees, plastic-reduction targets, and reporting rules.
- Designing a packaging reporting tool (MVP) to standardize multi-material disclosures across states, by consolidating state EPR requirements into one workflow with a focus on LCA-based fee exemptions.

Software Engineering Intern **May 2026 – Aug 2026**

Legali AI *Berkeley, CA*

- Shipped 6 production pages and 3 core platform features for an AI legal-help platform with 1,200+ quarterly active users, by translating Figma designs into Next.js, React, and Node.js.
- Opened the platform's 12-question legal-help quiz to non-English speakers and users with disabilities, so more people could reach legal support, by building multi-step state management across 7 languages and meeting WCAG accessibility standards.
- Kept releases on track across 3 repositories and 10+ merged PRs despite shifting specs, by clarifying requirements with the CEO, designer, and senior engineer through iterative code review.

Data Analytics Research Apprentice **Jan 2026 – May 2026**

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business (URAP) – Women's Health Nonprofit, India *Berkeley, CA*

- Cut research reporting time by 4 weeks for a women's health product study, by automating Python (Pandas) ETL workflows that consolidated raw multi-sheet trial data.
- Enabled regression analysis across 106 meeting locations and 1,200+ participants, by structuring control vs. treatment variables, auditing records for anomalies, and presenting findings to lead researchers.

Undergraduate Research Assistant **May 2024 – Sep 2025**

Conolly Lab & Tikhomirov Lab (Bioengineering) *Berkeley, CA*

- Developed nanoparticle tracers to sharpen magnetic particle imaging for medical imaging and biosensing, targeting 0.4 mT resolution in water.

Product Projects

Puffin: Drone Simulation Dashboard **Berkeley, CA**

Class Project, CS 160 (User Interface Design) – Figma, Full-Stack Web *Jun 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Replaced a fragmented 5-tool drone simulation setup with one browser dashboard, with 4 of 5 usability participants completing takeoff, by grounding the design in 4 needfinding interviews and 5 usability sessions.
- Shaped the dashboard's core user flows, by designing lo-fi screens and Figma prototypes and building the full-stack settings page.

Whirligig Beetle-Inspired Swimming Robot **Berkeley, CA**

Class Project, IB 130 (Bio-Inspired Design) – Arduino, CAD, Prototyping *Aug 2026 – Present*

- Designing a swimming robot with a 5-person team that mimics how whirligig beetles move on water, by translating the beetle's movement into the robot's mechanical design and prototyping it at Berkeley's Jacobs Hall makerspace.
- Building the robot's Arduino control system, by writing the control code and wiring the electronics.

Leadership & Community

Society of Women Engineers (SWE) **Berkeley, CA**

Evening with Industry Committee Officer *Aug 2025 – Present*

- Brought 8 partner companies to Berkeley's flagship technical networking conference (60+ attendees), by leading corporate sponsorship outreach and event logistics.

UC Berkeley Rec Well **Berkeley, CA**

FitStaff Operations Lead *May 2024 – Present*

- Keep a high-traffic campus gym running for 2.5+ years, by leading 2–3 staff per shift through openings, closings, and injuries.

Skills

Product: User Research & Interviews, Usability Testing, Feature Prioritization, Stakeholder Management
Design: Figma Prototyping, Wireframing, User Journey Mapping, Accessibility (WCAG)
Data & AI: Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, Machine Learning, Regression (OLS), Data Visualization, LLM APIs (Claude)
Engineering: JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, REST APIs, Git